

Writing Book Reviews

Example of a Book Review

Purpose: To review a book and inform others.

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

By Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland was written by Lewis Carroll in 1865. Born Charles Lutwidge Dodgson, Carroll had ten siblings and often made up stories and games to entertain them. At university, he used to look after the children of other staff and one day told the story of Alice to three children. They enjoyed it so much they asked him to write it down – so Carroll did. When he died in 1898, *Alice's Adventures in Wonderland* was the most popular children's book in England and is still one of the most well-known stories for children today.

The story is about Alice and her adventures in a fantastical place called Wonderland. Alice stumbles across Wonderland by following the White Rabbit down his rabbit hole, and her adventures begin. In Wonderland, she goes on lots of little adventures on her way, trying to get home, and learns that it's important not to take anything as it seems because everything is not as it looks! The protagonist, Alice, is a young girl who is quite clever and very fond of her cat. She thinks a lot, both out loud and to herself. The antagonist is the Queen of Hearts, who has a horrible temper and terrifies almost everyone in Wonderland. She is known for her catchphrase, "off with their heads!" The Cheshire Cat is one of the most helpful characters on Alice's adventure, as he turns up and gives her advice when she needs it most:

"Would you tell me, please, which way I ought to go from here?"

"That depends a good deal on where you want to get to," said the Cat.

"I don't much care where –" said Alice.

"Then it doesn't matter which way you go," said the Cat.

I enjoyed this book because it is nonsense. It is a nice escape from real life into Wonderland, and I think anyone feeling stressed about things would enjoy it. It was hard to read sometimes because of the time it was written – the language is a lot more formal than what we use today, so because of this I would recommend the book to readers about ten years old and up, or be read to by a grown-up. Lewis Carroll set out to entertain children with this story, and I think he did well. The proof of this is that his book has

been one of the most popular children's stories for more than a hundred years — it is so popular that even Disney made a film about it! Mostly I thought this story made sense as I read it, but sometimes I thought it was missing some structure along the way. I usually read fantasy novels where the protagonist is on a quest, and Alice is really just on a series of fantastical adventures with no real aim. I did enjoy that it was ridiculous, though, and it reminded me not to take things so seriously.

I give this book 4/5 stars.